



Vehicles for The Moon

Lexus is bored of designing vehicles for Earth, so they've set their sights on vehicles for the Moon now! <https://digit.in/feb20-67>



Blame it on Apple

Facebook VP says that Apple should be blamed for the Saudi hack on Besos' phone, not WhatsApp. <https://digit.in/feb20-68>

Samsung Galaxy Tab S6 LTE

The Android alternative to the iPad

The Samsung Galaxy Tab S6 is priced at roughly ₹60,000 for the LTE variant making it ₹10,000 cheaper than the entry-level Wi-Fi 11-inch iPad Pro and at par with the 256GB iPad Air Wi-Fi. Is it the alternative to the iPad we've been waiting for? Let's find out.

Build and design

Slim, elegant and well-built are the first things that will come to mind when you see the Galaxy Tab S6. The tablet has a metal back and not a glass one. It feels durable and looks like it can survive a few drops. The kickstand is the biggest addition. Not only does it have a housing for the S-Pen but the kickstand also lets you prop the tablet at all angles.

Moving to port placement, you have the power button and the volume rocker on the right, along with a tray for the SIM card and the microSD card slot. On the left, we have the keyboard dock connector. The headphone jack has vanished though. At the bottom, you have a USB-C port. The tablet also has 4 speakers which is a big boon in entertainment. The rear of the tablet has the camera in the upper right corner and the front has it bang in the centre of the top bezel. The fingerprint sensor is in-display. The S-Pen has the standard uses we've seen with the Note series, but on the larger real estate of the tablet, artists will really enjoy it. Add to it the fact that you can prop it at different angles thanks to the cover, and it can really give the iPad Pro a run for its money. The touch response shows minimal lag and there is good palm rejection.

Display and audio performance

Just like Samsung's flagship phones, the display is gorgeous. We consumed plenty of content and most of it looked



BUILD AND DESIGN.....82
PERFORMANCE.....89
FEATURES.....91
VALUE.....80

outstanding. Colours look vibrant and fantastic. We also tested the tablet under direct sunlight and it works quite well.

Coming to the audio, with the Galaxy Tab S6, we have great channel separation thanks to its four speakers. They are quite loud; louder than some budget laptops we've tested. Overall, the audio is clean, dialogue is clear and the speakers are loud enough that you don't need to huddle around a table to watch content on it.

Performance

When it comes to everyday performance, like checking mail, browsing the Internet, watching videos, etc. the tablet performed impressively without any stutter. It even works very well when you use apps in split-screen. With a Snapdragon 855 under the hood and 6GB RAM, no task is too tough for this device. The touch screen keyboard isn't as comfortable as the iPad's on-screen typing experience. However, the keyboard accessory that you can purchase is a lot better than the smart keyboard one can add to the iPad. Now, to some of the problems. To start with, the grip becomes annoying in tablet mode as you have "buttons" being pressed everytime

you adjust your grip since the keyboard folds backwards. Secondly, sometimes the keys register on the display when folded backwards and that can get annoying. When it comes to gaming, the tablet will run any game you throw at it with ease. From graphically heavy games like Asphalt, Call of Duty Mobile and PUBG Mobile to simple puzzle and shooting games, it all works on the Galaxy Tab S6 like a charm.

The Samsung Galaxy Tab S6 has a 7040mAh battery – in line with what we saw on the Galaxy Tab S4 and S5e. In our battery benchmark with the display on full brightness, the tablet died in a little over 7 hours, an improvement by an hour over the S5e. In real-world usage, it can last much longer. The battery life will vary based on usage and some productivity scenarios may see it drain faster.

Bottomline

The Tab S6 is truly the perfect alternative to the iPad. It has great performance for content creation as well as content consumption, the back cover ensures you can prop it at various angles adding to the ergonomics and the battery life is in line with what premium tablets offer these days. There are some ergonomic niggles and the standard slew of Android hiccups, but if you don't want to go for the iPad Pro, this is the best from the world of Android.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 10.50-inch Super AMOLED | RESOLUTION: 1600 x 2560 pixels | FRONT CAMERA: 8MP | REAR CAMERAS: 13MP, 5MP ultrawide | BATTERY CAPACITY: 7040mAh | OS: Android 9.0 (Pie); One UI | CHIPSET: Qualcomm Snapdragon 855 (7 nm) | CPU: Octa-core | GPU: Adreno 640 | RAM: 6GB/8GB | STORAGE: 128GB/256GB | FINGERPRINT SENSOR: Yes (under display)

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